

Meeting brief — Civic Readiness Portal

Audience: GNPS technology and curriculum leadership. **Purpose:** evaluate whether the Civic Readiness Portal solves a real district need and identify the proper review path.

One-sentence description

A workflow, evidence, and audit layer for the New York State Seal of Civic Readiness — students submit evidence, supervisors confirm, staff review against NYSED rubrics, Infinite Campus data auto-populates Civic Knowledge points, and a year-end NYSED audit pack is produced.

Leadership framing

Infinite Campus remains the system of record. The Civic Readiness Portal is a workflow, evidence, and audit layer.

Demo-live, pilot-live, and production-live are different things.

Technically deployable does not mean institutionally approved.

The prototype services are replaceable; the workflow is the value.

The district can choose its approved providers, hosting, identity, email, and database path after review.

I'm not asking to bypass IT. I'm asking for the right review path.

The remaining work is production governance: hosting, authentication, privacy, backups, accessibility, and ownership.

Problem solved

GNPS does not have a system for managing the NYS Seal of Civic Readiness. Peer Long Island districts (Seaford, Three Village, Connetquot) collect evidence with Microsoft / Google Forms feeding counselor inboxes — no central tracker, no live progress, manual end-of-year roll-up, and no audit-ready output. As a result, students who are *already* doing civic work in classes and clubs may not be recognized at graduation, and counselors carry the cost of re-keying SIS data and chasing supervisors.

The portal closes that gap by combining four things into one workflow:

1. **Public submission landing page** for service hours, projects, capstones, and reflections.
2. **Two-tier verification** — supervisor email confirmation plus counselor / SCRC review.
3. **Infinite Campus CSV import** that auto-counts Civic Knowledge points (SS credits, Regents, advanced coursework) without re-keying.
4. **Year-end NYSED audit pack** — per-student PDFs + roster CSV + evidence files, in one zip.

60-second pitch

Thank you for meeting with me. I built this because the Seal of Civic Readiness is a valuable opportunity for students, but the management side can become fragmented quickly. My goal was to prototype a workflow system that helps students submit evidence, helps staff review it, imports SIS data where appropriate, calculates points against NYSED criteria, and prepares a year-end audit package.

I'm not presenting this as something that should bypass IT review. I'm presenting it as a serious proof of concept. I'd like feedback from technology and curriculum leadership on whether this solves a real district need, what would need to change for security/privacy/compliance, and whether it is worth piloting or formally reviewing.

Architecture in plain language

- Single web application that staff sign into with a one-time email link.
- One Postgres database holding students, submissions, hours, evidence files, course data, Regents scores, users, and an audit log.
- Outbound email to a district SMTP relay for supervisor confirmations and staff sign-in.
- Optional Infinite Campus CSV import; live IC integration is deferred until IT review.
- Designed to run inside district infrastructure on a single Linux host with Docker, or on equivalent district-approved services.

Infinite Campus stays the system of record. The portal records workflow events (submissions, approvals, scores, exports) and prepares the NYSED audit pack at year-end.

Current technical stack

Recommended concrete production path (self-hosted):

- SvelteKit 2 on Node 22 — application server
- Postgres 16 — relational store
- Docker Compose — orchestration
- Caddy — reverse proxy with automatic Let's Encrypt SSL
- District SMTP — outbound email
- Self-hosted magic-link JWT sessions — staff authentication
- Filesystem (default) or S3-compatible — evidence storage

Live demo (prototype only): useful for evaluators to click around with sample data. It is not approved for real student records. The district can decide later whether production should run self-hosted, on district cloud, or on approved managed services.

What the prototype demonstrates

- Public submission flows for all 11 NYSED pathways
- Supervisor email confirmation (5-second click-to-confirm flow, no account needed)
- Counselor review queues, including reflection approval and hours verification
- SCRC topic approval and rubric scoring

- Infinite Campus CSV import with diff preview before commit, and auto-counted Civic Knowledge points
- Teacher quick-push for class-wide projects, with NYSED cap rules enforced
- Per-student PDF audit record and year-end NYSED audit-pack zip export
- Audit log on every state transition
- 121 automated tests, MIT-licensed open-source code

10-minute meeting demo path

1. **Open the landing page.** Say: "This is a prototype workflow, not a request to bypass IT. Infinite Campus remains the system of record."
2. **Show /submit.** Point out that students submit only what IC cannot already know: hours, projects, reflections, capstones, and advisor/supervisor evidence.
3. **Open one evidence form.** Emphasize required fields, supervisor confirmation, and the audit trail.
4. **Show staff login framing.** Say staff accounts are provisioned by admins; staff then request a one-time sign-in link. Production auth can stay magic-link or move to district SSO after review.
5. **Show admin import concept.** Explain the IC CSV import as the bridge from the SIS to auto-counted Civic Knowledge points.
6. **Show roster/export language.** Close with the year-end NYSED audit pack: the system reduces spreadsheet work and makes every point traceable.

Provider / service answer

If asked whether the district must use the current prototype services:

No. The public demo proves the workflow. The codebase is open source and v0.2.0 is fully self-hostable. GNPS Technology can choose the approved hosting, database, email, storage, identity, and backup path. My goal is to bring a serious prototype to the right review process, not to choose vendors for the district.

What remains for IT / curriculum review

- **Hosting.** Decide where the production deployment lives — district VM, district VMware/cloud tenancy, or another district-approved provider/service.
- **Authentication.** Today: self-hosted magic-link JWT sessions. Phase 2 option: ClassLink / Google Workspace / Azure AD SSO.
- **Privacy / FERPA.** Confirm the data flow (intake, review, evidence storage, IC import, audit export) meets district privacy requirements. Confirm the demo-data boundary — no real student data into any unapproved environment.
- **Database.** Postgres 16 inside Docker is the default. If district policy prefers a managed Postgres, the connection string is a single env var.
- **Email.** District SMTP; confirm authorized EMAIL_FROM address and SPF/DKIM if district policy requires.
- **Evidence storage.** Filesystem (default, on the host volume) or S3-compatible (district object store or approved cloud bucket).

- **Backups and disaster recovery.** Sample nightly `pg_dump` + evidence-file tarball is documented; needs alignment with district backup policy.
- **Accessibility.** Student- and staff-facing flows need an accessibility review before broad release.
- **Infinite Campus integration.** Phase 1: manual quarterly CSV upload (works today). Phase 2: live OneRoster API or nightly SFTP export — requires SIS administrator coordination.
- **Long-term ownership.** Technical owner, program owner, staff offboarding process, incident contact.
- **Transcript / write-back governance.** Out of scope for now; if it ever lands, it needs its own review.

Key phrases

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The prototype services are replaceable; the workflow is the value.

The district can choose the approved provider path.

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Codex / AI-assisted development framing

This project also shows a bigger opportunity. Teachers and curriculum leaders understand workflow problems, but usually cannot prototype solutions. A governed Codex or AI-assisted development pilot could let curriculum and IT evaluate ideas faster — not to bypass IT, but to make collaboration more concrete. Curriculum brings the workflow knowledge; IT brings the governance, hosting, and privacy review; AI-assisted development closes the prototype gap between them.

Ask to leadership

I'd like guidance on the right pathway: should this remain a demo, become a limited internal pilot, or enter formal production review? I'd also like IT's requirements around hosting, authentication, database, email, evidence storage, Infinite Campus integration, privacy, accessibility, and long-term ownership.